

CHANDNI KAPADIA: AN INSPIRING EPITOME OF EXCELLENCE

Success is the outcome of the passionate efforts that one puts in. But when one succeeds in every assignment taken up, it can only be the outcome of one's unending quest for excellence.

Chandni Kapadia is the Executive Director of the GLS University. She is also practicing law at Nanavati & Nanavati, Ahmedabad. And she is also an independent brand consultant for various international brands. An efficient multitasker, she loves to take up challenging roles, time and again and prove her mettle as a bold and efficient leader.

Chandni's journey is not easy to define. Stepping out of the confines of a sheltered, cloistered home, she travelled across the globe in her single minded obsession to work for Calvin Klien. Recalling her initial days, she says "As a young girl I may have been naïve, but one thing I was determined of - Manifestation of my dreams into reality and for that I was ready to challenge anything that came my way". Chandni pursued Fashion Merchandising from FIT and later did an MBA from London School of Economics. Having won against all odds, she has made it a habit of ignoring pessimists. She credits her parents support and her strong will for her success.

Her strong passion and singular focus on goals helped her become Country Head, Business Head, and Asia Pacific Head of many luxury brands. Success for her is continuously growing to become better version of oneself each day. She says "You are your biggest competitor and to sustain yourself in this changing world you should love what you do. I may have made few mistakes along the way but never have regretted my path which I have chosen for myself. I believe that it is indeed success when you have satisfaction of how far you've risen in something you've always loved."

In her interesting career, Chandni has been instrumental in launching Starbucks in India. Marquee Organizations like Earls Trading UK, Delta Trade International, Debenhams PLC all feature in her resume. She has excelled in her roles as Country Head, Business Head and Asia Pacific Head in companies like NEXT, Accessorize & Calvin Klein. She has run businesses and built brands with a clear headed strategic planning approach. From being a fashion consultant to getting a law degree with 11 gold medals, Chandni has excelled in all. She has always adapted to the circumstances yet stayed true to herself as "In the end what makes or breaks you is your inner self" she says. Her foray in the field of education has been almost a decade old. Today GLS University has collaborated with Ivy League universities like Harvard, Luiss Business School, CBU, New Castle and the list goes on. She says, "It is a big high when you play a huge role in making dreams come true". She feels blessed to have Shri Sudhir Nanavati as her mentor and to be a part of this huge institution that is family to her.

Chandni has been passionate about women empowerment. As a National Council President of WICCI & Director of Rotary Club of Visionaries of Mumbai, she has reached out to women

across the world and supporting their causes and businesses – a dream that she always had to give back to the society.

Chandni is also a strong advocate of prevention of cruelty against street dogs and works with various NGOs for it. For her, travelling and playing with her baby pet, Zoey, are the most relaxing things.

Over the years Chandni has herself turned into a brand, popularly known as "CK". She indeed has the Midas touch. Every venture that she has undertaken has been successful and she frequently keeps being asked this question "What next!!". ... To which she happily answers, "The Gold itself". She now is venturing into a jewellery line which would be specially crafted for the Indian women. A brand that would soon be the "Kolber" of India. CK is now waiting for the world to meet her newest venture with Pride Gold – her own, A Bespoke Jewellery Line CK's Pride which is bold and beautiful just like the Indian Women.

Chandni signs off with a message for youngsters, "Dreams won't ever work for you unless you do. So, channelize your mind and energy on the things that matter. Seeing that satisfied happy smile on your face at the end of having a fruitful day is always unmatched!!"



Chandni's Achievements and Recognitions:

1. World Women Leadership Congress Award for her immense contribution to fashion industry and also for Mumbai's Woman Leaders.
2. Women Entrepreneur Award and Rastriya Samman Puraskar by National Achievers' Recognition Forum.
3. Black Swan Award for Women Empowerment by AsiaOne in support of UN Global Compact Network & Government of India.
4. Self-Made Woman Award by Digilive, Asiaone.
5. Iconic Women Creating a Better World for All by Women Economic Forum, All Ladies League.
6. High Flyers' Appreciation Award 2021 in appreciation of Entrepreneurship
7. CEO of the Year Award by Indian Achievers' Forum in 2020
8. Awarded "Leaders of Change 2021" by Economic Times
9. Ms. Kapadia has also featured in Forbes List of Top 10 Women Entrepreneurs of India and in magazines like Fortune India, India Today and Outlook.
10. She has featured in Forbes India Women Power Issue and Business Today.